



Gerald Porter, PhD Artist Statement

We can never really know the world. It has too many faces and is inexhaustible even if behind the façade it is really very small. We can only behold it and allow ourselves to fully drink in what unfolds before us. We can never fully see the world; instead, we must be content with sensing its inchoate shapes and colors beyond what our physical senses can reveal. Painting, like all art, is suggestion. The unknown and mysterious world is revealed by art which points toward what the viewer may notice. Even though people for the most part don't know it, they are staring into a void - a void that is everything and nothing, a pregnant emptiness. If

you stare at a blank wall long enough, mere images evolve into whole realities.

As an artist, as a painter, I suggest what you as an observer might notice as you unwittingly create your reality. I can help shape that reality to be more engaging and exciting. But since you as the observer are creating your own experience, I am ultimately serving as a mirror to reveal you to yourself. I am the master of ceremonies for a ritual in which you use my art to discover yourself.

Gerald Porter "was a professor, a university administrator, a painter, and a poet. He was a jack-of-all-trades who loved to unravel the mysteries of the universe. He always loved the weirdness in the world and had a knack for finding it. My father taught me to debate and to argue, he taught me how words could crack the surface of a problem or idea to find the layers of meaning and history that lay beneath. He always preferred the path less traveled." David Bering-Porter, PhD.



Gerry was an accomplished and thoughtful scholar with decades of experience as a faculty member and administrator in higher education, and in training mental health counselors, school psychologists, and educators. In addition to serving as Provost and Senior Vice President of Fielding Graduate University, serving as Dean of the School of Education at Bastyr University and chairing the Department of Counseling and Psychological Services at SUNY Oswego, he held clinical and policy-level positions in the New York state government, specializing in meeting the needs of underserved and disenfranchised populations.